cluded within its protection. The historical purpose of the Fourteenth Amendment was clearly set forth when first considered by this Court in the *Slaughter House Cases,* 16 Wall. 36, decided April, 1873—less than five years after the proclamation of its adoption. Mr. Justice Miller speaking for the Court said (p. 70):

"Among the first acts of legislation adopted by several of the States in the legislative bodies which claimed to be in their normal relations with the Federal government, were laws which imposed upon the colored race onerous disabilities and burdens, and curtailed their rights in the pursuit of life, liberty, and property to such an extent that their freedom was of little value, while they had lost the protection which they had received from their former owners from motives both of interest and humanity. . . .

"These circumstances, whatever of falsehood or misconception may have been mingled with their presentation, forced . . . the conviction that something more was necessary in the way of constitutional protection to the unfortunate race who had suffered so much. . . . [Congressional leaders] accordingly passed through Congress the proposition for the *fourteenth amendment, and . . . declined to treat as restored to their full participation in the government of the Union the States which had been in insurrection,* until they ratified that article by a formal vote of their *legislative bodies.*"

Certainly, when the Fourteenth Amendment was submitted for approval, the people were not told that the states of the South were to be denied their normal relationship with the Federal Government unless they ratified an amendment granting new and revolutionary rights to corporations. This Court, when the *Slaughter House Cases* were decided in 1873, had apparently discovered no such purpose. The records of the time can be searched in vain for evidence that this Amendment was adopted for the benefit of corporations. It is true